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## SMALL BUSINESS SOURCES SOUGHT NOTICE (SSN)

### Scientific Evidence Evaluation and Knowledge Integration for Translational Toxicology

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**Agency:** NIH/National Institute of Environmental Health Sciences (NIEHS)

**Office:** Office of Acquisitions (OA)

**SSN Document no.:** NIH-OALM-NIEHS-2026-SIM

#### 1 PURPOSE

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This announcement constitutes a Sources Sought Notice (SSN) in accordance with *FAR Part 15.101 Early Exchanges with Industry*. **THIS SSN DOES NOT CONSTITUTE A SOLICITATION** (e.g., Invitation for Bids (IFB), Request for Proposal (RFP), Request for Quotation (RFQ), etc.) nor is it to be construed as a commitment by the Government. The information requested may be used as market research for planning purposes and to facilitate decision making (i.e., acquisition strategy determinations, availability of capable small business concerns, etc.). The information submitted will not be disclosed outside the Government. *Proprietary information submitted shall be appropriately marked* (see SSN Section 6 – *Other SSN Administrative Information* for additional information relating to Contractor proprietary information).

This Small Business Sources Sought (SSN) encourages responses from capable small businesses, to include all the socioeconomic categories.

NOTE: The Government will not be responsible for any costs incurred in responding to this SSN (or any possible Government follow-up questions / meetings relating to this SSN).

Not responding to this SSN does not preclude participation in any potential future solicitation.

#### 2 DESCRIPTION

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The National Institutes of Health (NIH), National Institute of Environmental Health Sciences (NIEHS) is seeking sources that possess the capabilities to support the 9 requirement areas under this contract that support DTT within NIEHS. These requirement areas include the following:

1. Systematic evidence mapping and scoping reviews of environmental health literature
2. Systematic review and evidence synthesis
3. Report development and scientific writing
4. Document preparation and publication
5. Coordination and management of external peer review
6. Logistical management for advisory group meetings and workshops

7. Provision of scientific or technical consultants with expertise in relevant scientific disciplines
8. Development and implementation of novel tools and informatics approaches
9. Program management

The DRAFT Statement of Work (SOW) has been attached for reference purposes and includes additional requirement details.

#### **PLACE OF PERFORMANCE**

TBD

#### **ESTIMATED PERIODS OF PERFORMANCE**

The anticipated Period of Performance is ten (10) years (a base year with nine (9) option years) with an estimated start date of May 2027.

### **3 BACKGROUND**

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#### **3.1 PROGRAM INFORMATION**

The National Institute of Environmental Health Sciences (NIEHS), located in the Research Triangle Park, North Carolina, is one of the 27 Institutes and Centers comprising the National Institutes of Health (NIH). The NIEHS is a multidisciplinary research institution with the primary mission of conducting research to discover how the environment influences the development and progression of human disease in order to promote healthier lives. NIEHS focuses on basic science, disease-oriented research, global environmental health, clinical research, and multidisciplinary training for researchers.

The Division of Translational Toxicology (DTT) is an intramural division of the NIEHS, NIH. DTT uses traditional and cutting-edge approaches to better understand how factors in the environment may impact human health. Such approaches include using scientific expertise to identify, collect, analyze, and interpret diverse types of information relevant to the effects of environmental exposures on human health. Information from the fields of toxicology, epidemiology, chemistry, data science, informatics, pathology, and other disciplines is used in the design of research programs; in literature-based health assessments; and in the development of novel tools and informatics approaches.

#### **3.2 CURRENT CONTRACT**

This is not a new requirement. The original contract (GS00Q14OADU417 Order No. HHSN273201600015U) was awarded in 2016 to ICF Incorporated, LLC, as a R&D Cost Plus Fixed Fee Level of Effort contract, procured under full and open competition. This award included a base period, multiple option periods, and an optional 6-month extension in accordance with FAR 52.217-8, for a total contract period of performance of 10.5 years. A subsequent sole-source bridge contract (75N96025C00003) was awarded in 2025 to ICF Incorporated, LLC, to extend the length of the contract. This award includes a base period, option period, and an optional 6-month extension in accordance with FAR 52.217-8, for a total contract period of performance of 2 years.

### **4 INFORMATION REQUESTED**

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Interested Parties in assisting NIEHS with this market research are requested to submit the

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following information in the format of a White Paper outlined below. The response should be concise (no more than 20 pages), 11 pt Calibri font, and address only the information requested below. Bulleted lists and summaries are acceptable. (Note: title pages, cover letters, etc., will not count against the total page limit). Responses are to be submitted electronically to: [Lisa.schaupp@nih.gov](mailto:Lisa.schaupp@nih.gov) and [filardok@nih.gov](mailto:filardok@nih.gov).

*Generic capability statements will not be provided to the requirements team for review.*

Interested Parties shall provide the following information:

**I. COMPANY INFORMATION**

- a. Company Name
- b. CAGE Code
- c. Point of Contact Name, Phone Number, and E-mail Address
- d. Company Website
- e. ALL government contract vehicles under which the Company holds contracts (e.g., GSA Federal Supply Schedule (FSS), NITAAC, OASIS, etc.)

**II. BUSINESS SIZE**

- a. The anticipated NAICS for this effort is 541715, Research and Development in the Physical, Engineering, and Life Sciences (except Nanotechnology and Biotechnology). The Small Business Administration (SBA) small business size standard for this NAICS code is 1000 employees.
- b. Based on the NAICS 541715, identify your business size as Small or Large.
- c. If a small business concern, identify which, if any, of the below small business socio-economic categories are applicable:

|                                                                |                          |
|----------------------------------------------------------------|--------------------------|
| Small Disadvantaged Business (SDB)                             | <input type="checkbox"/> |
| Woman-Owned Small Business (WOSB)                              | <input type="checkbox"/> |
| Economically Disadvantaged Woman-Owned Small Business (EDWOSB) | <input type="checkbox"/> |
| Veteran-Owned Small Business (VOSB)                            | <input type="checkbox"/> |
| Service-Disabled Veteran-Owned Small Business (SDVOSB)         | <input type="checkbox"/> |
| HUBZone Small Business (HZ)                                    | <input type="checkbox"/> |

- d. If your company is an Other Than Small Business (OTSB) concern (i.e., large business), have you partnered or subcontracted with small business concerns to provide the same or similar services as this requirement?

**III. CAPABILITIES**

- a. Generally, describe your company's capabilities in fulfilling the requirements of the attached draft Statement of Work.

b. Specifically, address the information in subparagraphs *i. through iii.* below:

- i. Concisely describe your company's ability to perform the work described in the below areas. Include supporting information which demonstrates your company's knowledge / capability to meet the requirements of the DRAFT SOW tasks. *Supporting information shall not reiterate the language of the tasks provided in the DRAFT SOW;* rather it shall provide details regarding your company's knowledge/capability to execute these tasks. NIEHS is not asking for disclosure of specific or detailed innovative solutions; however, specific examples would assist the Government with this SSN.

If your company does not have direct experience, please explain how you would perform tasks utilizing experienced subcontractors, through a proposed contract teaming arrangement (CTA), or hiring qualified personnel.

The specific areas are the following:

1. Systematic evidence mapping and scoping reviews of environmental health literature
2. Systematic review and evidence synthesis
3. Report development and scientific writing
4. Document preparation and publication
5. Coordination and management of external peer review
6. Logistical management for advisory group meetings and workshops
7. Provision of scientific or technical consultants with expertise in relevant scientific disciplines
8. Development and implementation of novel tools and informatics approaches
9. Program management

- ii. Has your company performed work of the same or similar scope as this requirement within the last three (3) years? Please explain.

For any contracts or projects for the same or similar work performed by your company within the last three (3) years, please provide the following information: (no more than three (3) examples; government or commercial contracts):

- Brief Description of the Contract/Project
- Contract Number
- Period of Performance
- Contract Type(s) (e.g., FFP, T&M, Labor-Hour (LH), etc.)
- Commercial or Non-Commercial Requirement?
- Was your company a prime or subcontractor?
- Contract/Project Dollar Value
- Scope of the portion of the effort your company supported

- iii. Provide additional relevant experience/ information that demonstrates your company's capabilities.

## 5 SSN SUBMISSION INSTRUCTIONS

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### 5.1 QUESTIONS

Questions regarding this SSN shall be received no later than **12:00 PM Eastern Time (ET) on 30 April 2026**. Questions received by the due date/time will be answered and provided to all respondents in the form of an SSN Amendment. Questions received after the due date/time may not be answered.

Questions shall be submitted in writing via e-mail to Kristina Filardo at [filardok@nih.gov](mailto:filardok@nih.gov) and Lisa Schaupp at [lisa.schaupp@nih.gov](mailto:lisa.schaupp@nih.gov) and shall reference this SSN.

### 5.2 SSN RESPONSES

Responses to this SSN shall be received no later than **4:00 PM Eastern Time (ET) on 6 May 2026** as identified the SSN's online SAM.gov (formerly FBO) posting. (If there is a difference in SSN response date/time between this document and the online posting, the online posting shall take precedence.)

Responses shall be submitted electronically via e-mail to all parties listed below in Section 5.3 - SSN Points of Contact and shall reference this SSN.

*All SSN responses will be reviewed and utilized for market research.*

### 5.3 SSN POINTS OF CONTACT

**Contract Specialist:** Kristina Filardo @ [filardok@nih.gov](mailto:filardok@nih.gov)

**Contracting Officer:** Lisa Schaupp @ [lisa.schaupp@nih.gov](mailto:lisa.schaupp@nih.gov)

## 6 OTHER SSN ADMINISTRATIVE INFORMATION

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All information received in response to this notice that is marked "Proprietary" will be handled accordingly. The Government reserves the right to use any non-proprietary information submitted by, or obtained from, a Respondent in any manner NIEHS determines is appropriate including, but not limited to, the creation of a competitive solicitation. Any proprietary data that is included in the response must be marked appropriately at the paragraph level (or at a more granular level as required; page level is acceptable for full page table, graphs, etc.). Any response marked proprietary at the document level will not be considered.

NIEHS personnel may contact any company responding to this SSN to clarify its capabilities/product/ other matters as part of its market research.

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Respondents are advised that the Government is under no obligation to acknowledge receipt of the information received or provide feedback to Responders with respect to any information submitted. Responses to this notice will not be returned.

## **7 ATTACHMENT(S)**

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- DRAFT Statement of Work (SOW)

## **8 FAR PROVISIONS**

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The following provision is applicable to this notice and is hereby incorporated by reference:

*FAR 52.215-3: Request for Information or Solicitation for Planning Purposes (Oct 1997).*

The full text of this provision is available at: <https://www.acquisition.gov/far/52.215-3>.